

2000text1

一、文章中英文主旨

中文主旨

本文围绕美国经济的兴衰与转型展开，先讲述二战后美国凭借绝对优势迎来经济黄金发展期，随后20世纪80年代因其他国家经济崛起遭遇产业竞争力持续下滑的危机与国民信心动摇，最终90年代通过产业结构调整实现经济稳步复苏，重获发展优势与市场信心。

英文主旨

This article focuses on the rise, decline and transformation of the U.S. economy. It first depicts the golden economic period of the United States after World War II with absolute competitive advantages, then elaborates the crisis of declining industrial competitiveness and shaken national confidence in the 1980s caused by the rise of other countries' economies, and finally introduces that the U.S. achieved steady economic recovery, regained development advantages and market confidence through industrial restructuring in the 1990s.

二、逐句精读解析

第一段

1. **原文**: A history of long and effortless success can be a dreadful handicap, but, if properly handled, it may become a driving force.

译文: 一段长期且毫不费力的成功史，可能成为一种可怕的障碍，但如果处理得当，它也可能转化为一种驱动力。

常考词汇&短语:

- effortless adj. 不费力的；轻松的
- dreadful adj. 可怕的；糟糕的
- handicap n. 障碍；不利条件 v. 妨碍；阻碍
- properly handled 妥善处理；恰当应对
- driving force 驱动力；推动力

长难句分析:

本句为并列复合句，由转折连词 **but** 连接两个分句。

- 分句1: **A history of long and effortless success can be a dreadful handicap** (主系表结构，主语为 **A history of long and effortless success**)
 - 分句2: **if properly handled** 是插入式的条件状语从句 (省略了 **it is**，完整形式为 **if it is properly handled**，**it** 指代前文的 **a history of long and effortless success**)，主句为 **it may become a driving force** (主系表结构)。
2. **原文**: When the United States entered just such a glowing period after the end of the Second World War, it had a market eight times larger than any competitor, giving its industries unparalleled economies of scale.
- 译文**: 二战结束后，美国恰好进入了这样一段辉煌时期，其市场规模是任何竞争对手的8倍，这使其工业获得了无与伦比的规模经济效应。
- 常考词汇&短语**:
- glowing adj. 辉煌的；蒸蒸日上的；热情洋溢的
 - competitor n. 竞争者；对手
 - unparalleled adj. 无可匹敌的；无与伦比的

- economies of scale 规模经济

长难句分析：

本句为复合句，结构如下：

- 时间状语从句：when the United States entered just such a glowing period after the end of the Second World War，由 when 引导，交代事件背景
- 主句：it had a market eight times larger than any competitor（主谓宾结构，eight times larger than any competitor 为后置定语修饰 market，是考研核心倍数表达结构）
- 结果状语：giving its industries unparalleled economies of scale，现在分词短语作结果状语，修饰主句内容，表主句动作带来的必然结果。

3. 原文：Its scientists were the world's best; its workers the most skilled.

译文：它的科学家是世界上最顶尖的，它的工人是技术最娴熟的。

常考词汇&短语：

- skilled adj. 技术熟练的；有技能的

句式补充：本句为并列分句，后一个分句省略了与前一分句相同的系动词 were，完整形式为 its workers were the most skilled，是英文中常见的省略句式，避免重复。

4. 原文：America and Americans were prosperous beyond the dreams of the Europeans and Asians whose economies the war had destroyed.

译文：美国的繁荣和美国人的富足，是那些经济遭到战争摧毁的欧亚各国人民做梦也无法想象的。

常考词汇&短语：

- prosperous adj. 繁荣的；富足的
- beyond the dreams of 超出.....的想象；做梦也想不到

长难句分析：

本句为复合句，包含定语从句：

- 主句：America and Americans were prosperous beyond the dreams of the Europeans and Asians（主系表结构，beyond the dreams of... 作程度状语）
- 定语从句：whose economies the war had destroyed，由关系代词 whose 引导，修饰先行词 the Europeans and Asians，whose 在从句中作定语修饰 economies，从句正常语序为 the war had destroyed whose economies。

第二段

1. 原文：It was inevitable that this primacy should have narrowed as other countries grew richer.

译文：随着其他国家日益富裕，美国的这种领先优势必然会被削弱，这是不可避免的。

常考词汇&短语：

- inevitable adj. 不可避免的；必然发生的
- primacy n. 领先地位；首要地位；卓越
- narrow v. 缩小；收窄 adj. 狭窄的

长难句分析：

本句为考研核心形式主语句型，结构如下：

- 形式主语：It，指代后文 that 引导的主语从句
- 系表结构：was inevitable
- 真正主语：that this primacy should have narrowed as other countries grew richer，其中 as 引导时间状语从句，表“随着”，修饰主语从句的核心动作。

2. 原文：Just as inevitably, the retreat from predominance proved painful.

译文：同样不可避免的是，从领先地位上退下来的过程被证明是痛苦的。

常考词汇&短语：

- retreat n. 后退；撤退；退出
- predominance n. 主导地位；优势；霸主地位
- prove v. 证明是；被发现是；证实

3. **原文**: By the mid-1980s Americans had found themselves at a loss over their fading industrial competitiveness.

译文: 到20世纪80年代中期, 美国人发现自己对日益衰退的工业竞争力感到茫然无措。

常考词汇&短语:

- mid-1980s 20世纪80年代中期
- at a loss over 对.....茫然无措; 对.....不知所措
- fading adj. 衰退的; 衰减的; 逐渐消失的
- competitiveness n. 竞争力

4. **原文**: Some huge American industries, such as consumer electronics, had shrunk or vanished in the face of foreign competition.

译文: 面对国外的竞争, 美国一些大型产业, 比如消费电子产业, 已经萎缩甚至消失。

常考词汇&短语:

- consumer electronics 消费电子; 消费类电子产品
- shrink v. 萎缩; 收缩; 缩小 (过去分词shrunk)
- vanish v. 消失; 消亡; 不复存在
- in the face of 面对; 面临

5. **原文**: By 1987 there was only one American television maker left, Zenith. (Now there is none: Zenith was bought by South Korea's LG Electronics in July.)

译文: 到1987年, 美国仅剩一家电视机生产商——天顶公司。(如今一家都没有了: 天顶公司已于当年7月被韩国LG电子收购。)

常考词汇&短语:

- maker n. 生产商; 制造商; 制造者
- buy v. 收购; 购买 (过去分词bought)

6. **原文**: Foreign-made cars and textiles were sweeping into the domestic market.

译文: 外国制造的汽车和纺织品正大举涌入美国国内市场。

常考词汇&短语:

- foreign-made adj. 外国制造的; 进口的
- textile n. 纺织品; 纺织业
- sweep into 大举涌入; 横扫进入
- domestic market 国内市场

7. **原文**: America's machine-tool industry was on the ropes.

译文: 美国的机床产业岌岌可危。

常考词汇&短语:

- machine-tool industry 机床产业; 机床工业
- on the ropes 岌岌可危; 濒临崩溃; 处于困境 (考研高频固定习语, 源自拳击运动, 指被击倒在擂台围绳上)

8. **原文**: For a while it looked as though the making of semiconductors, which America had invented and which sat at the heart of the new computer age, was going to be the next casualty.

译文: 曾有一段时间, 半导体制造业似乎也要成为下一个牺牲品, 而半导体正是美国发明的, 且处于新计算机时代的核心领域。

常考词汇&短语:

- for a while 一度; 有一段时间
- semiconductor n. 半导体
- at the heart of 处于.....的核心; 是.....的核心
- casualty n. 牺牲品; 受害者; 伤亡人员

长难句分析:

本句为复合句, 包含表语从句和两个并列的非限制性定语从句, 是考研高频长难句类型, 结构如下:

- 主句: **it looked as though...**, **it**为形式主语, **as though**引导表语从句
- 表语从句主干: **the making of semiconductors was going to be the next casualty**

- 插入的非限制性定语从句：which America had invented 和 which sat at the heart of the new computer age，两个从句由 and 并列，均由 which 引导，修饰先行词 the making of semiconductors，补充说明半导体的核心背景信息。

第三段

1. **原文**：All of this caused a crisis of confidence.

译文：所有这一切引发了一场信心危机。

常考词汇&短语：

- a crisis of confidence 信心危机

2. **原文**：Americans stopped taking prosperity for granted.

译文：美国人不再将繁荣视为理所当然。

常考词汇&短语：

- take...for granted 认为.....理所当然；把.....视作理所当然（考研核心固定搭配）

3. **原文**：They began to believe that their way of doing business was failing, and that their incomes would therefore shortly begin to fall as well.

译文：他们开始认为，自己的经营方式正在失效，因此他们的收入很快也会随之下降。

常考词汇&短语：

- way of doing business 经营方式；商业模式
- fail v. 失效；失败；失灵
- therefore adv. 因此；所以
- shortly adv. 很快；不久；立刻

长难句分析：

本句为复合句，主句包含两个并列的宾语从句，是考研宾语从句的核心考点：

- 主句：They began to believe...
- 宾语从句1：that their way of doing business was failing
- 宾语从句2：that their incomes would therefore shortly begin to fall as well，由 and 连接，与第一个从句并列，共同作 believe 的宾语，第二个 that 不可省略。

4. **原文**：The mid-1980s brought one inquiry after another into the causes of America's industrial decline.

译文：20世纪80年代中期，人们对美国工业衰退的原因展开了一次又一次的调查。

常考词汇&短语：

- one inquiry after another 一次又一次的调查；接连不断的调查
- inquiry into 对.....的调查；对.....的探究
- industrial decline 工业衰退；产业衰落

5. **原文**：Their sometimes sensational findings were filled with warnings about the growing competition from overseas.

译文：这些调查时而耸人听闻的发现，充斥着对海外竞争日益加剧的警示。

常考词汇&短语：

- sensational adj. 耸人听闻的；轰动性的；夸张的
 - be filled with 充满；充斥着
 - warning about 关于.....的警示；对.....的警告
 - overseas adv./adj. 海外（的）；国外（的）
-

第四段

1. **原文**: How things have changed!

译文: 世事变化真是天翻地覆!

2. **原文**: In 1995 the United States can look back on five years of solid growth while Japan has been struggling.

译文: 1995年, 美国可以回顾过去五年的稳健增长, 而日本却一直在苦苦挣扎。

常考词汇&短语:

- look back on 回顾; 回望
- solid growth 稳健增长; 稳步增长
- struggle v. 挣扎; 艰难前行; 苦苦支撑

3. **原文**: Few Americans attribute this solely to such obvious causes as a devalued dollar or the turning of the business cycle.

译文: 很少有美国人将这一增长仅仅归因于美元贬值或商业周期轮回这些显而易见的原因。

常考词汇&短语:

- attribute...to... 将.....归因于.....; 把.....归咎于..... (考研核心固定搭配)
- solely adv. 仅仅; 唯一地; 单独地
- devalued adj. 贬值的 (动词devalue, 意为贬值)
- business cycle 商业周期; 经济周期

4. **原文**: Self-doubt has yielded to blind pride.

译文: 自我怀疑已被盲目自大取代。

常考词汇&短语:

- self-doubt n. 自我怀疑
- yield to 被.....取代; 屈服于; 让位于
- blind pride 盲目自大; 盲目的骄傲

5. **原文**: "American industry has changed its structure, has gone on a diet, has learnt to be more quick-witted," according to Richard Cavanaugh, executive dean of Harvard's Kennedy School of Government.

译文: 哈佛大学肯尼迪政府学院执行院长理查德·卡瓦纳夫称: "美国工业已经改变了结构, 精简了机构, 学会了更灵活机敏地应对市场。"

常考词汇&短语:

- change structure 改变结构; 结构调整
- go on a diet 节食; (喻) 精简机构; 缩减规模 (经济类文章高频比喻用法)
- quick-witted adj. 机敏的; 灵活的; 思维敏捷的
- executive dean 执行院长

句式补充: 句中 has changed..., has gone on..., has learnt to... 为三个并列的谓语结构, 用排比的方式增强语势; go on a diet 此处为比喻用法, 并非字面的“节食”, 而是指企业精简冗余业务、缩减成本, 是考研经济类文章的常用表达。

6. **原文**: "It makes me proud to be an American just to see how our businesses are improving their productivity," says Stephen Moore of the Cato Institute, a think-tank in Washington, DC.

译文: 华盛顿特区的智库卡托研究所的斯蒂芬·摩尔说: "看到我们的企业正在提升生产率, 我为自己是美国人而感到自豪。"

常考词汇&短语:

- productivity n. 生产率; 生产效率
- think-tank n. 智库; 智囊团

长难句分析:

本句为倒装句, 直接引语前置, 主语和谓语完全倒装, 正常语序为 Stephen Moore of the Cato Institute... says + 直接引语, 是考研阅读中人物观点句的高频句式。

- 直接引语中, it 为形式主语, 真正的主语为后面的不定式 to see how our businesses are improving their productivity

- how 引导宾语从句，作 see 的宾语；a think-tank in Washington, DC 是 Cato Institute 的同位语，补充说明其属性。

7. 原文：And William Sahlman of the Harvard Business School believes that people will look back on this period as “a golden age of business management in the United States.”

译文：哈佛商学院的威廉·萨尔曼则认为，人们回顾这段时期时，会将其视为“美国企业管理的黄金时代”。

常考词汇&短语：

- Harvard Business School 哈佛商学院
- look back on...as... 将.....回顾为.....；把.....视作.....
- golden age 黄金时代
- business management 企业管理；商业管理

长难句分析：

本句为复合句，主句为 William Sahlman... believes...，that 引导宾语从句，作 believes 的宾语，宾语从句的核心结构为 people will look back on this period as...。

三、完整原文

A history of long and effortless success can be a dreadful handicap, but, if properly handled, it may become a driving force. When the United States entered just such a glowing period after the end of the Second World War, it had a market eight times larger than any competitor, giving its industries unparalleled economies of scale. Its scientists were the world's best; its workers the most skilled. America and Americans were prosperous beyond the dreams of the Europeans and Asians whose economies the war had destroyed.

It was inevitable that this primacy should have narrowed as other countries grew richer. Just as inevitably, the retreat from predominance proved painful. By the mid-1980s Americans had found themselves at a loss over their fading industrial competitiveness. Some huge American industries, such as consumer electronics, had shrunk or vanished in the face of foreign competition. By 1987 there was only one American television maker left, Zenith. (Now there is none: Zenith was bought by South Korea's LG Electronics in July.) Foreign-made cars and textiles were sweeping into the domestic market. America's machine-tool industry was on the ropes. For a while it looked as though the making of semiconductors, which America had invented and which sat at the heart of the new computer age, was going to be the next casualty.

All of this caused a crisis of confidence. Americans stopped taking prosperity for granted. They began to believe that their way of doing business was failing, and that their incomes would therefore shortly begin to fall as well. The mid-1980s brought one inquiry after another into the causes of America's industrial decline. Their sometimes sensational findings were filled with warnings about the growing competition from overseas.

How things have changed! In 1995 the United States can look back on five years of solid growth while Japan has been struggling. Few Americans attribute this solely to such obvious causes as a devalued dollar or the turning of the business cycle. Self-doubt has yielded to blind pride. “American industry has changed its structure, has gone on a diet, has learnt to be more quick-witted,” according to Richard Cavanaugh, executive dean of Harvard's Kennedy School of Government. “It makes me proud to be an American just to see how our businesses are improving their productivity,” says Stephen Moore of the Cato Institute, a think-tank in Washington, DC. And William Sahlman of the Harvard Business School believes that people will look back on this period as “a golden age of business management in the United States.”

四、完整译文

一段长期且毫不费力的成功史，可能成为一种可怕的障碍，但如果处理得当，它也可能转化为一种驱动力。二战结束后，美国恰好进入了这样一段辉煌时期，其市场规模是任何竞争对手的8倍，这使其工业获得了无与伦比的规模经济效应。它的科学家是世界上最顶尖的，它的工人是技术最娴熟的。美国的繁荣和美国人的富足，是那些经济遭到战争摧毁的欧亚各国人民做梦也无法想象的。

随着其他国家日益富裕，美国的这种领先优势必然会被削弱，这是不可避免的。同样不可避免的是，从领先地位上退下来的过程被证明是痛苦的。到20世纪80年代中期，美国人发现自己对日益衰退的工业竞争力感到茫然无措。面对国外的竞争，美国一些大型产业，比如消费电子产业，已经萎缩甚至消失。到1987年，美国仅剩一家电视机生产商——天顶公司。（如今一家都没有了：天顶公司已于当年7月被韩国LG电子收购。）外国制造的汽车和纺织品正大举涌入美国国内市场。美国的机床产业岌岌可危。曾有一段时间，半导体制造业似乎也要成为下一个牺牲品，而半导体正是美国发明的，且处于新计算机时代的核心领域。

所有这一切引发了一场信心危机。美国人不再将繁荣视为理所当然。他们开始认为，自己的经营方式正在失效，因此他们的收入很快也会随之下降。20世纪80年代中期，人们对美国工业衰退的原因展开了一次又一次的调查。这些调查时而耸人听闻的发现，充斥着对海外竞争日益加剧的警示。

世事变化真是天翻地覆！1995年，美国可以回顾过去五年的稳健增长，而日本却一直在苦苦挣扎。很少有美国人将这一增长仅仅归因于美元贬值或商业周期轮回这些显而易见的原因。自我怀疑已被盲目自大取代。哈佛大学肯尼迪政府学院执行院长理查德·卡瓦纳夫称：“美国工业已经改变了结构，精简了机构，学会了更灵活机敏地应对市场。”华盛顿特区的智库卡托研究所的斯蒂芬·摩尔说：“看到我们的企业正在提升生产率，我为自己是美国人而感到自豪。”哈佛商学院的威廉·萨尔曼则认为，人们回顾这段时期时，会将其视为“美国企业管理的黄金时代”。